

SHANTANU GUPTA

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SUMMARY

Product Researcher with 4+ years of experience planning and executing evaluative, generative, and market research across AI products, games, AR/VR, and higher education. Experienced in user interviews, usability testing, surveys, competitive analysis, and product analytics, translating research findings into product recommendations and strategic decisions.

SKILLS

Research Methods: User Interviews, Usability Testing, Survey Design, Competitive Analysis, Customer Discovery, Stakeholder Interviews, Persona Development, Mixed-Methods Research, Market Research, A/B Testing.

Analytics & Tools: SQL, Tableau, Snowflake, Google Analytics, Funnel Analysis, Cohort Analysis, User Segmentation, Jira

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product Researcher, Invent Artificial (Contract), Remote, US Feb. 2026-Present

- Evaluated AI-powered mock interview experiences across technical, behavioral, and HR scenarios to assess question quality, AI feedback, scoring accuracy, and overall user experience.
- Benchmarked competing AI interview platforms to identify feature gaps, market opportunities, and product differentiation.
- Interviewed approximately **15 users** to evaluate onboarding, ATS resume evaluation, AI-generated feedback, and overall usability, translating findings into recommendations that informed feature prioritization.

Product Researcher, Mighty Warners LLC (Contract), Remote, US Jul. 2025-Oct. 2025

- Evaluated an AR/VR retail concept through market, competitor, and early user research, supporting product planning and go-to-market discussions for the U.S. market.

Product Researcher & Customer Discovery, Nova Codes, Boston, MA Jul. 2024-Jul. 2025

- Conducted customer discovery by reaching out to **10–15 prospective clients daily** and interviewing qualified prospects to understand product goals, gameplay requirements, and project constraints.
- Moderated usability sessions for in-development games, identifying usability issues and gameplay friction to support iterative design improvements.
- Synthesized customer discovery findings and usability insights into product recommendations shared with development teams.

Program Research & Engagement Analyst, Northeastern University, Boston, MA Nov. 2022-May. 2024

- Analyzed engagement trends using Snowflake and Google Analytics, contributing to initiatives that increased alumni engagement by **25%**, website traffic by **15%**, and LinkedIn/YouTube engagement by **17%**.
- Conducted stakeholder interviews with alumni, students, faculty, and industry professionals to identify opportunities for improving curriculum, student engagement, and program positioning.
- Coordinated industry engagement initiatives, including the university's presence at GDC, collecting practitioner feedback on student projects to strengthen industry partnerships.

Market Research Analyst, iTAP Entertainment & Gaming, Mumbai, India Sep. 2021-Aug. 2022

- Analyzed player behavior through surveys, SQL, and competitive research to identify market opportunities and inform product strategy.
- Developed five player personas and consumer insights that contributed to **20% higher early retention** and **18% stronger campaign performance**.
- Synthesized competitor and market insights into recommendations supporting feature planning and product strategy.

Business Analyst - Sales & Market Intelligence (Summer Associate), Sunteck Realty, Mumbai, India Jun. 2021-Sep. 2021

- Built Tableau dashboards and synthesized market intelligence to support strategic planning, contributing to **13% revenue growth**.

EDUCATION

Northeastern University, Boston, MA

Master of Science (M.S), Game Science and Design (Interactive Technologies) - STEM

May. 2024

Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies, NMIMS Mumbai, India

Master of Business Administration (M.B.A), Technology Management (Marketing & Business Intelligence)

Aug. 2022

Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies, NMIMS Mumbai, India

Bachelor of Technology (B. Tech), Computer Engineering

Aug. 2020

PUBLICATIONS & PROJECTS

Power Dependency and Cooperative Player Behavior in Multiplayer Game Design

Jan. 2026

- Designed and executed a mixed-methods study with **16 participants across eight cooperative gameplay sessions**, combining gameplay observation, surveys, and behavioral coding to investigate cooperative player behavior.

DOI: https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/wdy9h_v1

Gambit's Gauntlet, Northeastern University, Boston, MA

Sep. 2023-May. 2024

- Led mixed-methods user research for a Unity-based cooperative game, conducting gameplay observation, usability testing, surveys, and behavioral analysis to improve player engagement.